Good News / Shepherds / Finale

Current company version · generated from the structured master script

CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

SCENE 12 — GOOD NEWS / SHEPHERDS / FINALE

CONTINUOUS FROM SCENE 11

No blackout.

The baby has cried. The world has gone still.

Mary has invited Joseph closer and placed the child into his arms.

Do not restart the scene emotionally. We begin inside the silence Scene 11 created.

Joseph looks down at the child.

Mary watches him.

Another small sound from the baby.

MARY
You’re good at that.

Joseph barely looks up.

JOSEPH
I have no idea what I’m doing.

MARY
Neither does he.

Joseph looks at the child again.

A tiny smile.

JOSEPH
Then we’ll learn together.

No declaration of ownership. No explanation of the arc.

Joseph adjusts the cloth around the child with extraordinary care.

The man who once said, “The child... it’s not mine,” now answers that wound through presence and responsibility.

“SILENT NIGHT”

Only now does the quiet musical phrase from Scene 11 continue.

One voice.

Then another.

No full choir. No applause-oriented solo.

Mary, Joseph and the child remain the center.

Anna may remain just outside the family image.

As the music continues, a separate pool of darkness slowly appears elsewhere.

The manger remains visible.

THE SHEPHERD FIELD

Night. Cold. Open land.

The LED is environmental here: a wide, dark horizon, distant suggestion of Bethlehem, no supernatural imagery yet.

Shepherd 1, Shepherd 2 and the Young Shepherd are working. They are not waiting reverently for a Bible story to happen.

The Young Shepherd tries to redirect a stubborn sheep.

YOUNG SHEPHERD
Come on.

Nothing.

SHEPHERD 2
Having trouble?

YOUNG SHEPHERD
A little.

SHEPHERD 2
It’s a sheep.

YOUNG SHEPHERD
I know.

Shepherd 1 redirects the animal.

SHEPHERD 1
Don’t argue with sheep.

SHEPHERD 2
You won’t win.

The Young Shepherd pulls the cloak tighter.

YOUNG SHEPHERD
I’m cold.

SHEPHERD 2
We’re all cold.

SHEPHERD 1
Morning will come.

YOUNG SHEPHERD
Good.

A tiny laugh.

Then the animals become still.

Shepherd 1 notices first.

SHEPHERD 1
Wait.

SHEPHERD 2
What?

SHEPHERD 1
Listen.

SILENCE.

SHEPHERD 2
I don’t hear anything.

SHEPHERD 1
Exactly.

A low atmospheric sound begins.

The Young Shepherd looks into the changing darkness.

YOUNG SHEPHERD
What’s that?

SHEPHERD 1
Stay close.

HEAVEN INTERRUPTS

This is the production’s largest supernatural transformation.

The familiar horizon begins to lose its physical logic. Haze reveals immense architecture made by light. The LED no longer behaves like landscape; depth becomes impossible. Sound expands beyond the apparent stage.

Avoid literal giant angels, clouds, wings, galaxies, or a video illustration of heaven.

ANGEL VOICE
Do not be afraid.

The shepherds freeze.

SHEPHERD 2
I’m trying.

A nervous breath of laughter may release, then disappears.

ANGEL VOICE
I bring you good news of great joy for all people.

The shepherds listen.

ANGEL VOICE
Tonight, in the city of David, a Savior has been born.

Beat.

ANGEL VOICE
You will know Him by this sign: you will find a baby wrapped in cloth, lying in a manger.

YOUNG SHEPHERD
A manger?

HEAVEN EXPANDS.

For one concentrated moment, use the production’s full supernatural vocabulary: dimensional light through haze, transformed LED space, spatial sound and heavenly voices.

HEAVENLY VOICES
GLORY TO GOD IN THE HIGHEST!

Powerful. Brief.

EVERYTHING STOPS.

Night returns.

The ordinary horizon becomes recognizable again.

SILENCE.

The three shepherds stare at the place where the impossible just happened.

SHEPHERD 2
Did that really happen?

SHEPHERD 1
Yes.

The Young Shepherd looks toward Bethlehem.

YOUNG SHEPHERD
Let’s go.

SHEPHERD 2
Right now?

Shepherd 1 looks toward Bethlehem.

SHEPHERD 1
Right now.

They choose the road before they understand the whole story.

They move.

THE SEARCH

SHEPHERD UNDERSCORE

Bethlehem reappears around them: narrow passages, sleeping households, travelers, closed doors.

The supernatural light does not follow them. They must now walk through an ordinary city.

SHEPHERD 2
How do we find one baby in Bethlehem?

SHEPHERD 1
Remember the sign.

YOUNG SHEPHERD
A manger.

SHEPHERD 2
So we’re looking for a baby where babies usually aren’t.

The Young Shepherd sees Eli’s property.

YOUNG SHEPHERD
There!

They hurry.

KNOCK. KNOCK.

Eli opens the door, exhausted.

INNKEEPER ELI
Yes?

SHEPHERD 1
Forgive us. We’re looking for a baby.

INNKEEPER ELI
A baby?

SHEPHERD 2
Born tonight.

INNKEEPER ELI
There are quite a few people in Bethlehem tonight.

SHEPHERD 1
An angel sent us.

Eli stops.

INNKEEPER ELI
An angel?

SHEPHERD 2
That’s what we said.

INNKEEPER ELI
What did he tell you?

SHEPHERD 1
That we’d find a baby wrapped in cloth—

YOUNG SHEPHERD
In a manger.

Beat.

Eli looks toward the rear of the property.

INNKEEPER ELI
A manger.

He understands enough.

INNKEEPER ELI
Come with me.

They start.

INNKEEPER ELI
Quietly.

The shepherds enter.

THE SHEPHERDS ARRIVE

Eli leads them toward the animal shelter.

Their excitement becomes uncertainty as they realize they are approaching a sleeping family, not a palace.

Joseph hears footsteps and rises.

JOSEPH
Eli?

INNKEEPER ELI
It’s all right.

Joseph sees the shepherds.

INNKEEPER ELI
They came looking for the baby.

Joseph looks at Mary.

Then at the strangers.

JOSEPH
Why?

Shepherd 1 takes a small step forward.

SHEPHERD 1
We were told we'd find Him here.

Joseph does not understand.

Eli steps aside.

The shepherds enter.

The Young Shepherd sees the feeding trough.

Stops.

YOUNG SHEPHERD
The manger.

Shepherd 1 sees the child.

SILENCE.

No angelic lighting returns.

No supernatural underscore tells them how to feel.

They have found an ordinary baby in an ordinary feeding trough—and the sign is exactly right.

AT THE MANGER

Mary watches these strangers carefully.

MARY
How did you know?

SHEPHERD 1
An angel came to us.

Mary and Joseph exchange a look.

SHEPHERD 2
He said a Savior had been born tonight.

SHEPHERD 1
And that we'd find Him here.

The Young Shepherd looks at the manger.

YOUNG SHEPHERD
We found Him.

SILENCE.

Mary looks at the child.

She did not tell these men.

She did not persuade them.

She did not defend herself.

They came already carrying confirmation.

THE SHEPHERDS RESPOND

SHEPHERD 1
I’m glad we came.

Mary looks at him.

MARY
So am I.

THE NAME

The Young Shepherd looks at the child.

Then at Joseph.

YOUNG SHEPHERD
What’s His name?

SILENCE.

Give this time.

Joseph looks at the child.

Then Mary.

Mary looks back at Joseph.

The angel gave Joseph this responsibility. Now he accepts it publicly.

Joseph picks up the baby from Mary and turns toward the shepherds.

JOSEPH
His name is……

Music suspends…

JOSEPH
Jesus.

Music hold

The Young Shepherd kneels first.

Shepherd 1 follows.

Shepherd 2 slowly kneels.

Music orchestra is playing

NIA AND SIMON RETURN

A warm pool of light appears downstage.

NIA and SIMON step into it.

Behind them, Mary, Joseph, Jesus, and the kneeling shepherds remain visible.

The orchestra continues softly underneath.

NIA
Remember Nazareth?

SIMON
Small town. Ordinary people.

NIA
Mary thought she knew what came next.

SIMON
Joseph did too.

Beat.

NIA
But that night...

everything changed forever.

The STAR begins to intensify.

SIMON
People were coming from near—

NIA
—and far—

SIMON
to see the miracle that had taken place.

SIMON
A child had been born.

NIA
A promise had been fulfilled.

SIMON
And a Savior had come.

Beat.

Nia looks at Simon.

Simon looks toward the manger.

Then together, they turn toward the audience.

NIA & SIMON

And from one small town, through ordinary people who chose to trust God... the world would never be the same.

MUSIC SWELLS IMMEDIATELY.

THE COMPANY RETURNS

As the Wise Men begin their journey through the audience, a familiar sound appears almost beneath perception.

OHHH-OH... OOOH-OOH-OOH...

The musical DNA of Scene 1.

Mary's friends emerge: Shira, Talia, Adina, Dafna.

Joseph's friends: Levi, Malachi, Caleb, Ezra.

Then children, villagers, dancers, praise team and choir.

They are not literally entering Bethlehem.

They are the company telling the story.

Do not rebuild Nazareth.

The manger remains visible and central.

FINAL MUSICAL NUMBER — "WELCOME TO NAZARETH" TRANSFORMED

The opening musical identity becomes unmistakable.

COMPANY

OHHH-OH... OOOH-OOH-OOH...

The audience recognizes where the story began.

At the opening, the musical idea meant: Welcome to an ordinary place.

Now it means: Look what began in an ordinary place.

Build the finale as one continuous arrangement rather than a sequence of separate reprises.

THREE WISE MEN APPEAR IN THE AISLES.

Each carries a gift.

They begin a slow, dignified procession down the aisle towards the stage

Nia and Simon watch them for a moment.

FINALE BUILD — ONE MUSICAL SPINE

Children and Nia/Simon begin with recognizable Scene 1 movement vocabulary: baskets, fabric, claps, and simple traveling patterns.

Mary's and Joseph's friends layer into the architecture. Their presence carries their journeys; no dialogue explains who believed, doubted, or changed.

The shepherds rise and join the musical celebration.

The Wise Men continue their slow procession toward the stage.

Inside the "Welcome to Nazareth" arrangement, brief musical memories surface organically

A restrained "Chosen" phrase — once Mary's private question, now heard in a larger community.

A brief "My Beloved / Still Yours" instrumental color — Mary and Joseph see one another across the manger.

A "Walk With You" figure — the promise has changed from certainty about the road to choosing to continue walking.

Do not stop the finale to announce these callbacks. They should be discoveries inside the same musical river.

THE WISE MEN / VISUAL EXPANSION

The Wise Men reach the stage during the musical build.

Their gifts may be presented ceremonially without dialogue.

Shepherds and Wise Men occupy different visual territories: different people, different journeys, same child.

Avoid allowing the procession to block Mary, Joseph, or Jesus.

THE DANCE CELEBRATION

The music opens into the final choreographic celebration.

Use the strongest Scene 1 movement DNA in transformed form: traveling diagonals, turns, layered levels, partner movement where appropriate, fabric, baskets, lanterns, rhythmic tool accents and age-appropriate children's movement.

Mary and Joseph do not join the full-out choreography.

They have earned stillness.

The world moves around them.

The LED may now echo the distinctive Nazareth horizon from Scene 1, transformed and widened—not as a literal return to town, but as a visual memory of where this story began.

FINAL VOCAL BUILD

Children join vocally.

Friends.

Shepherds.

Praise Team / Choir.

Full Company.

The arrangement reaches the production’s largest musical scale.

The title idea “CHOSEN” may become the final resolved sung thought, but it should emerge from the established finale rather than feel attached as a second ending.

No spoken explanation follows it.

FINAL SUNG STATEMENT.

FINAL CHORD.

THE SPECTACLE SURRENDERS

Do not freeze immediately into a crowded Christmas card.

Over the final sustained musical and lighting counts, simplify.

Dancers finish their final traveling phrase and become still.

Outer movement stops.

The company’s eyelines begin returning toward the child.

The LED’s movement slows.

The strongest peripheral light reduces.

The audience’s eye is deliberately guided inward.

FINAL IMAGE

Mary, Joseph and Jesus remain low and central.

The Young Shepherd may kneel nearest the family.

Shepherds occupy one side.

Wise Men occupy the opposite side, gifts visible.

Nia and Simon remain offset and visible without competing for focus.

Friends, children, villagers, praise team and company form layered heights farther out.

Dancers frame the outer picture.

Warm gold and deep night-blue may remain in the larger environment, with the star visible above.

Then the outer world reduces another degree.

What remains emotionally is

MARY.

JOSEPH.

JESUS.

No narration.

No sermon.

No “Merry Christmas.”

No adult-Jesus montage.

No crucifixion or resurrection imagery.

The manger is enough.

HOLD.

One.

Two.

Three.

FAST, CLEAN BLACKOUT.

END OF CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER